PADHAKU
Exploring Society: India and Beyond · Class 6 Social Science



CHAPTER 10

Grassroots Democracy – Part 1: Governance

NCERT Exercise Solutions

The Big Questions	3 Q
Let's Explore · Introduction	3 Q
Let's Explore · Government in daily life	3 Q
Let's Explore · Three Organs of Government	2 Q
Let's Explore · Three Levels of Government	2 Q
Questions, activities and projects	4 Q

✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

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? The Big Questions

1 What is the meaning of ‘governance’?

✔ ANSWER

Governance is the process of taking decisions, organising the society’s life with different sets of rules, and making sure that these rules are followed.

Without governance, people living together would face disagreements and disorder.

2 Why do we need a government?

✔ ANSWER

A **government** is the group of people or the system that makes the rules (laws) and ensures that they are followed.

We need it because:

- when many people live together, rules are needed to keep order and harmony;
- someone must make laws, implement them and punish those who break them;
- it provides public services and helps people in emergencies like floods.

No country can run without governance and government.

3 **What is the meaning of ‘democracy’? Why is it important?**

✔ ANSWER

‘Democracy’ comes from two Greek words — **dēmos** (‘people’) and **kratos** (‘rule’ or ‘power’). So democracy means the **‘rule of the people’**.

In a democracy, people elect representatives (MLAs, MPs) who make laws for them.

It is important because citizens have a say in the laws and decisions that affect their lives, and differences are settled through dialogue and debate, not force.

⭐ Let’s Explore · Introduction

1 **Describe the two pictures given in Fig. 10.1 — what differences do you see between them?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

One picture shows people following rules — orderly traffic and people waiting their turn, so everything runs smoothly.

The other shows the same kind of place with no rules followed — confusion, jams and people pushing each other.

Difference: **order and safety** in the first, **disorder and trouble** in the second. (check the picture in your book)

2 **How do you connect this with our discussion on rules?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

The pictures show what the text says: when people follow rules, society works smoothly; when no one follows rules, there is disorder and society cannot function.

3 **What are some of the rules in your school? Who made them?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Sample rules:

- Come to school on time and wear the uniform.
- Stand in a line during assembly.
- Keep the classroom and campus clean.
- Do not damage school property.

Who made them: the school management / principal with teachers, often following rules of the Education Department. Some class rules may be decided with students.

⭐ Let's Explore · Government in daily life

1 **Can you identify the categories of public service or other activities that are represented in the ten pictures in Fig. 10.2?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Likely categories (check the picture in your book):

- Education (schools)
- Health (hospitals, vaccination)
- Transport (roads, railways, buses)
- Law and order (police)
- Defence (army)
- Water supply and electricity
- Post and communication
- Agriculture
- Cleanliness and sanitation
- Disaster relief

2 **What role do you think the government plays in each of these activities?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

The government plans, pays for and runs these services, and makes rules for them. For example:

- builds and runs schools, gives free books and mid-day meals;
- runs hospitals and vaccination drives;
- builds roads and runs railways;

- keeps law and order through the police and protects borders through the army;
- supplies water and electricity, and helps people during disasters.

3 **Can you think of other aspects of your daily life where the government plays an important role?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

- Ration shops (cheap food grains)
- Traffic signals and driving licences
- Birth certificates, Aadhaar cards
- Parks, street lights and garbage collection
- Currency notes and coins we use
- Safe medicines and food quality checks

⭐ Let's Explore · Three Organs of Government

1 **Explain how the three government organs are at work in the case of the cyber criminals described above. How do they intervene?**

✔ **ANSWER**

- **Legislature:** passed new laws against cybercrime (stealing money through digital means).
- **Executive:** implements these laws — the **cyber police** find and arrest the criminals.

- **Judiciary:** the court decides whether they broke the law and gives punishment — usually a **fine and jail** for some years.

2 **As a class activity, can you imagine the sort of disorder we might witness if all three organs were under the control of the same group of people? Can you describe any such real-life situation you may have heard of?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

If one group made the laws, carried them out and also judged cases:

- it could make unfair laws to help itself;
- it could punish anyone it disliked, with no one to stop it;
- people would have no fair court to go to; there would be no checks and balances.

Real-life example: rule by a dictator or an absolute king, where one person or group holds all power and people's rights are not protected.

⭐ Let's Explore · Three Levels of Government

1 **Observe the table (Fig. 10.5). Highlight the functions and responsibilities that affect your life the most.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Sample answer:

- **State level:** education, public health, police / law and order, agriculture and irrigation, local government.
- **Central level:** education, currency, communications, defence.

These affect a student's daily life the most — school, health care, safety and the money we use.

2 **Ask two or three adults about their connection or interaction with the government — at what levels does it take place and for what purpose?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Sample answer:

Person	Level	Purpose
Father	Local (panchayat / municipality)	Water connection, birth certificate
Mother	State	Ration card, government hospital
Uncle	Central	Passport, income tax, bank / post office scheme

? Questions, activities and projects

1 **Test yourself — What is the meaning of democracy? What is the difference between**

direct democracy and representative democracy?

✔ ANSWER

Democracy means the **'rule of the people'** (Greek *dēmos* = people, *kratos* = rule/power).

Direct democracy	Representative democracy
Every person votes on the decision directly	People elect representatives who decide for them
Possible in a small group, e.g. a class voting by raising hands for a picnic place	Used in large groups, e.g. India: citizens elect MLAs and MPs

India is a **representative democracy** — the world's largest, with some 970 million voters in 2024.

2 **Recall the three organs of government. What are their different roles?**

✔ ANSWER

- **Legislature:** makes new laws, and updates or removes old ones (e.g. Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha, Vidhan Sabha).
- **Executive:** implements (executes) the laws — head of state, ministers and agencies like the police.

- **Judiciary:** the system of courts; decides if someone broke the law and what punishment to give; also checks whether executive decisions and laws are right and fair.

They are kept separate (**separation of powers**) so that each can check the others.

3 **Why do we need three tiers of government?**

✔ ANSWER

Different problems need different levels of action, and each level deals with different matters:

- **Local** (village/town): small, local problems — e.g. a small flood in part of a district.
- **State:** bigger problems in many towns and villages — e.g. sends rescue teams.
- **Central (national):** matters for the whole country, and very big problems — e.g. a massive flood: relief supplies, the army.

This way work is shared and problems are handled at the right level, and ordinary citizens can take part at the grassroots.

4 **Project: Many of you will remember the lockdown that took place during the COVID-19 pandemic. Make a list of all the actions that were taken at that time. Which tiers of government were involved in managing the**

situation? What was the role of each of the organs of government?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Actions: lockdown; schools and offices closed; masks and distancing; testing and hospitals; free ration; vaccination; online classes; special trains to take workers home.

Tiers involved: **all three**:

- Central: announced the national lockdown, rules and vaccination drive, free food grains.
- State: ran hospitals, police checks, local rules, distributed ration.
- Local: panchayats/municipalities did sanitisation, helped with containment zones, awareness and vaccination camps.

Organs:

- Legislature: passed or used laws (e.g. on epidemic and disaster management) and funds.
- Executive: made and enforced lockdown rules, health services, relief.
- Judiciary: heard cases about migrant workers, oxygen and medicines, and gave directions; courts also worked online.

🎉 **Chapter 10 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**